

0.0.1 sampasādaniya discourse on

Sariputta's Lion's Roar

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Nalanda at the Pavarika Mango Grove. Then the venerable Sāriputta visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Sāriputta said this to the Auspicious One: “Thus, O Bhante, is my belief in the Auspicious One: Neither has there been, nor will there be, nor does there exist now, another samaṇa or brahmana who has higher supreme knowledge than the Auspicious One, namely, [with regard to] awakening.”

2. Lofty, O Sāriputta, is this bold utterance of yours. You have definitely established a roaring of a lion's roar: “Thus, O Bhante, is my belief in the Auspicious One: Neither has there been, nor will there be, nor does there exist now, another samaṇa or brahmana who has higher supreme knowledge than the Auspicious One, namely, [with regard to] awakening.” How is this, O Sāriputta? Have you encompassed the minds of all those arahants, supremely awakened Buddhas of the past with your own mind so as to know that: “Those Auspicious Ones were of such virtue, those Auspicious Ones were of such dhamma, those Auspicious Ones were of such wisdom, those Auspicious Ones were of such dwelling, those Auspicious Ones were of such liberation?”

3. Certainly not, O Bhante.

4. Then how is this, O Sāriputta? Have you encompassed the minds of all those arahants, supremely awakened Buddhas to come in the future with your own mind so as to know that: “Those Auspicious Ones will be of such virtue, those Auspicious Ones will be of such dhamma, those Auspicious Ones will be of such wisdom, those Auspicious Ones will be of such dwelling, those Auspicious Ones will be of such liberation?”

5. Certainly not, O Bhante.

6. Then how is this, O Sāriputta? I am presently the arahant, supremely awakened Buddha. Have you encompassed my mind with your own mind so as to know that: “This Auspicious One is of such virtue, those Auspicious Ones is of such dhamma, those Auspicious Ones is of such wisdom, those Auspicious Ones is of such dwelling, those Auspicious Ones is of such liberation?”

7. Certainly not, O Bhante.

8. So indeed here, O Sāriputta, you do not have knowledge of the minds of the arahants, supremely awakened Buddhas of the past, future or present. What then, O sāriputta, is this lofty, bold utterance of yours, having definately established a roaring of a lion’s roar: “Thus, O

Bhante, is my belief in the Auspicious One: Neither has there been, nor will there be, nor does there exist now, another samaṇa or brahmana who has higher supreme knowledge than the Auspicious One, namely, [with regard to] awakening.”

9. I, O Bhante, do not have knowledge of the minds of the arahants, supremely awakened Buddhas of the past, future or present. Nevertheless, the drift of the dhamma, O Bhante, is known by me. Suppose, O Bhante, that a king's border town would have a strong surrounding rampart with one door. There the gate keeper would be wise, competent, clever, one who keeps out those who are unknown, one who lets in those who are known. For him walking along the encircling path around the town on all sides, would not see even so much as a gap in the wall or a crack in the wall large enough for a cat to slip through. It will occur to him: “Whatever gross living beings are entering or leaving this town, all those enter or leave only by this gate.” So too, O Bhante, the drift of the dhamma is known by me. Whichever arahants, O Bhante, were supremely awakened Buddhas of the past, all those Auspicious Ones, having abandoned the five hindrances, mental defilements that are weakeners of wisdom, having enculturated the seven awakening factors with a mind well established in four establishments of mindfulness, they supremely awakened to the supreme awakening.

10. Whichever arahants will be supremely awakened Buddhas in the future, all those Auspicious Ones, having abandoned the five hindrances, mental defilements that are weakeners of wisdom, having enculturated the seven awakening factors with a mind well established in four establishments of mindfulness, they will supremely awakened to the supreme awakening. The Auspicious One too at present, O Bhante, the Arahant, the supremely awakened one, having abandoned the five hindrances, mental defilements that are weakeners of wisdom, having enculturated the seven awakening factors with a mind well established in four establishments of mindfulness, has rightly awakened to the supreme awakening.

11. Here I, O Bhante, visited with the Auspicious One for the sake of hearing the dhamma. For me, O Bhante, the Auspicious One taught the dhamma, [revealing] the highest of the highs, the most excellent of the excellent, the dark and the bright, along with their counterparts. I in just the way, O Bhante, as the Auspicious One taught me the dhamma, [revealing] the highest of the highs, the most excellent of the excellent, the dark and the bright, along with their counterparts, In just that way, from supremely knowing certain dhammas in that teaching, I acquired faith in the Teacher and arrived at a conclusion: Indeed, the Auspicious One is supremely awakened. The Dhamma is well-proclaimed by the Auspicious One. The Sangha of the Auspicious One's disciples has entered upon the good path.